



Bound resilience: Guillaume Junior Atangana of the Refugee Paralympic Team competes in the men's 400m T11 at the World Para Athletics Championships, running in tandem with his guide Donard Nyamjua — a partnership forged through resilience, trust, and a shared journey from exile to triumph. GETTYIMAGES

because he isn't a machine. You depend on another person. If either of you is injured, you can't train. But Donard is very special to me. I have no vision at all, which was caused by a bad reaction to medication, so Donard helps me not just on the track but in my day-to-day life. We are always together. We go shopping together. We chill and even go to the park together. I'm lucky I have him as my guide.

Donard: It never crossed my mind that I should head to England by myself. What would I do alone? The journey to England was a dangerous one. But Guillaume told me that we would go as one. There was no

guarantee of success. Guillaume told me if the worst was to happen, neither of us would be to blame. But luckily we reached England safely.

In England too, our plan was always to run together. Of course, when we first arrived, there was no guarantee we would ever be able to compete again. Without any papers, we couldn't even find a place to train. That was hard because the most important thing for a guide and runner is to train constantly together.

We did what we could — jogging early in the morning in the parks. When I got work, Guillaume would either call to wake me up or knock on my door so that we could run before I left for my job.

We have gone through so much together that even now I prefer to spend my free time with him. There are times when we fight or get angry, but that happens with everyone. We know that we care for each other and will always run together. I think we are already one person because our spirit is already

linked. That's what makes us run freely.

'To be a good guide you need to sacrifice yourself'

Runner: Nancy Koech Chelangat

Guide: Geoffrey Kiplangat (Kenya)

T11 women's 1500m silver

Geoffrey: I was a runner for the Kenyan team. In 2018, I won a bronze in the World Youth Championships in the 3000m steeplechase. But I decided to stop running for myself because I wanted to do something for my younger sister. She is six years younger than me. I wanted her to realise that there was a future for her as well.

A lot of my friends tried to discourage me, especially because I was still very young when I decided to become a guide runner and scale back my own training. They said, "You still have your career in front of you," but I had made my decision. Running as a guide is very different from running for yourself, especially in the longer distances. I'm much